

Curriculum Vitae

(Last updated: 2026-05-03)

Seung June Kwon

1. Education and Training

- 2023 - 2026 **Ph.D.** in Biology (June 2026)
Graduate School of Systems Life Sciences,
Kyushu University, Fukuoka, Japan
Thesis: A Study on the Molecular Basis of Skeletal Diversity
Using Avian Sterna as a Model
Advisor: Yuji Atsuta, Ph.D.
- 2021 - 2023 **M.S.** in Biology
Graduate School of Systems Life Sciences,
Kyushu University, Fukuoka, Japan
- 2020 **Research Intern** (Summer)
Boditech Med, R&D Hormone Team, Chuncheon, South Korea
- 2019 **Exchange Student**
Department of Chemistry and Bioscience,
Kagoshima University, Kagoshima, Japan
- 2017 - 2021 **B.S.** in Biology
Department of Molecular Biology,
Jeonbuk National University, Jeonju, South Korea
Graduated with ***Summa cum laude*** (Ranked 1st in the Department)

2. Publications

1. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Egawa, S., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y. Heterochronic activation of TGF- β signaling drives the diversity of the avian sterna. ***Nature Communications***, 2026
2. Kuriyama, S.*, Shigematsu, K.*, **Kwon, S.J.**, Kuwata, R., and Atsuta, Y. Optimization of Culture and Transfection Methods for Primary Snake Cells. ***Development, Growth & Differentiation***, 67: 279-292, 2025 (**Cover article**)
3. Suzuki, K.*, **Kwon, S.J.*** (**equal contribution**), Saito, D., and Atsuta, Y. LIN28 is essential for the maintenance of chicken primordial germ cells. ***Cells & Development***, 176: 203874, 2023 (**Cover article**)

3. Conferences and Presentations

Invited Talk

Kwon, S.J., Zou, Z., Honda, M., Egawa, S., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Heterochronic activation of TGF- β signaling drives the diversity of avian sterna”, Invited seminar, Laboratory of Prof. Patrick Tschopp, Department of Environmental Sciences, University of Basel, Switzerland, September 2025

Oral Presentations

1. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Egawa, S., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Unraveling the molecular basis underlying sternal diversification in birds”, 15th GfE School, Günzburg, Germany, September 2025 (**Travel Award**)
2. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Molecular Basis of the Sternal Diversification in Chicken and Emu”, 57th Annual Meeting of the Japanese Society of Developmental Biologists, Kyoto, Japan, June 2024
3. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Molecular mechanisms underlying avian sternal diversification”, 8th Unique-Kai, Kagoshima, Japan, June 2024 [Japanese] (**Travel Award**)
4. **Kwon, S.J.**, Suzuki, K., Matsumoto, K., and Atsuta, Y., “Visualizing & Filtering the Bulk RNA-Seq Data”, Next Generation Sequencing Meeting of the Japanese Society of Developmental Biologists, Okazaki, Japan, December 2022 [Japanese] (**Travel Award**)

Poster Presentations

1. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Molecular basis of the avian sternum diversification”, 1st Evo-Devo Young Researchers Meeting, Okazaki, Japan, March 2025 [Japanese] (**Travel Award**)
2. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Molecular Basis Underlying the Sternal Diversification in Birds”, 47th Annual Meeting of the Molecular Biology Society of Japan, Fukuoka, Japan, November 2024
3. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Comparative study of the sternal development between chicken and emu”, 56th Annual Meeting of the Japanese Society of Developmental Biologists, Sendai, Japan, July 2023
4. **Kwon, S.J.**, Zou, Z., Honda, M., Oki, S., and Atsuta, Y., “Comparative study of the sternal development between chicken and emu”, 4th German and Japanese Society of Developmental Biologists (GfE-JSDB) Young Scientist Exchange Meeting, Sendai, Japan, July 2023

4. Awards and Honors

2026 **Travel Grant**, Kato Memorial Bioscience Foundation
2025 Japan Society for the Promotion of Science (JSPS) Research Fellow (DC2)
 Final-Year Special Research Grant
2024 - 2026 **JSPS Research Fellow (DC2)**

2024 **Nice Presentation Award**, Kyushu University
Graduate School of Systems Life Sciences All Lab Poster Contest

2023 **Excellent Presentation Award**, 8th Unique-Kai

2023 **Japan Science and Technology Agency Research Fellow (SPRING)**

2022, 2023 **Research Excellence Scholarship**, Kyushu University

2021 **President's Award (*Summa cum laude*; Department Topper)**
Department of Molecular Biology, Jeonbuk National University

2020 **National Science and Engineering Undergraduate Scholarship**, South Korea

5. Teaching

2025 - 2026 **Teaching Fellow**, Department of Biology, Kyushu University
2026 Spring semester: Molecular Biology; Cell Biology
2025 Fall semester: Developmental Biology; Biology Seminar

2024 **Advanced Teaching Assistant**, Department of Biology, Kyushu University
2024 Spring semester: Molecular Biology Lab Course

6. Outreach

Kwon, S.J., "Studying abroad and research in graduate school", 7th Special Seminar in
Department of Biology, Kyushu University, November 2024 [Japanese]

7. Language Qualifications

English: TOEIC 985 / 999 (October 2025), TOEFL 107 / 120 (March 2021)

Japanese: JLPT N1 180 / 180 (perfect score, August 2019)

Korean: Native